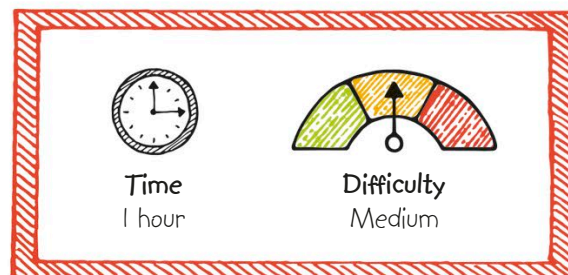


HOW TO MAKE A DNA MODEL

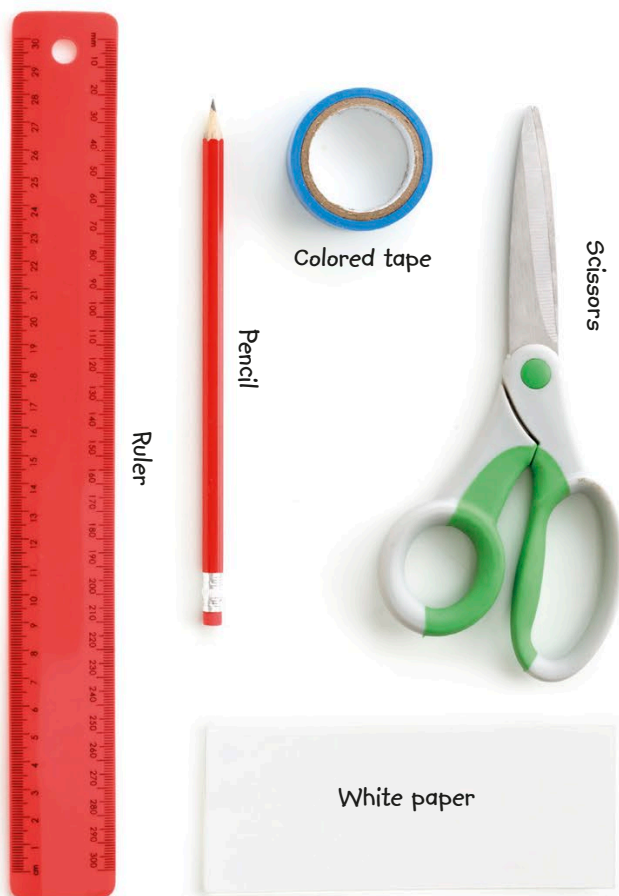
Your finished model of DNA will have a shape like a twisted rope ladder—just like real DNA. It's important to use four different colors when you make the "rungs" of the ladder, because each color represents one of four different chemicals. You use tape for the "ropes" at the sides of the ladder, which in real DNA are also types of chemicals.



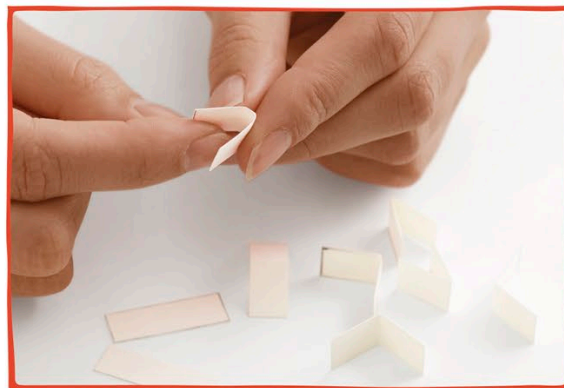
WHAT YOU NEED



Highlighter pens in four different colors



1 With a pencil and ruler, mark the paper into about 30 strips, each $\frac{1}{2}$ in (1cm) wide and $1\frac{1}{4}$ in (3cm) long. Cut out the strips with scissors. These are the rungs of the ladder and each one represents a pair of chemicals known as bases.



2 Take each strip and pinch a crease halfway along its length. The crease marks the dividing line between two bases. In real DNA, the two bases in each rung are held together by a chemical bond.